

PIN CUSHION

Make the front

With fabric A right side down, centre the card template on top of the fabric. Either finger press or use an iron to press the sides of the fabric over the template, starting by folding over the corners. Continue folding over and pressing the fabric over the card. Remove the card and press again. Find the centre of the fabric by folding the square in half and pressing the fold. Repeat again in the opposite direction and press lightly. With the fabric still right side down, fold up and press each corner of the square to the centre mark on the fabric. Press all sides. Catch stitch the four corner points in place. Repeat the folding process again on the four sides, pressing the creases but not stitching them in place.

Open up the four triangular flaps and place fabric B, right side up, on the plain fabric, using the creases as a guide. Fold the triangular flaps in so the points meet in the centre. Pin all four outside corners and pin the four points in the centre, then anchor the points in the centre through all the layers with a few cross stitches.

Pin the four half-square fabric C triangles right side up to each of the triangular flaps, 3mm ($\frac{1}{8}$ in) inside the edge of fabric A. Roll the edge of fabric A over fabric C, curving fabric A so the rolled edge is wider in the middle and narrower at each end, forming a "petal" shape. Pin as required. Repeat on the remaining seven edges. Increase the stitch size on your machine slightly, then top stitch along the rolled edge, beginning in the centre. Repeat for the seven remaining curves.



Make the back

On the reverse of one fabric D rectangle, measure 4cm ($1\frac{1}{2}$ in) down along one long edge. Rotate the rectangle 180 degrees and repeat on the other side. Place the second rectangle under the first, right sides together and, leaving a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance, stitch to the mark, backstitching to finish. Rotate and stitch to the mark again, leaving a gap of approximately 4cm ($1\frac{1}{2}$ in). Finger press the seam open.

Place the front and back of the cushion right sides together. Align and pin the edges in place. Stitch around the four sides, then trim off the excess fabric so the raw edges are neat. Gently turn the cushion through the opening in the back seam, pushing out the corners.

Stuff and button the cushion

Stuff the cushion and oversew the gap in the back by hand. Stitch the shanked button to the front of the cushion with double thread, passing the needle through to the back and through the washer button. Pull the thread to compress the pin cushion and tie the thread off securely.

Materials

FOR BOTH PROJECTS

- * Threads to match your fabrics
- * Iron & ironing board
- * Sewing needle
- * Pins
- * Sewing machine
- * Scissors



FOR PIN CUSHION

- * 22 x 22cm ($8\frac{1}{2}$ x $8\frac{1}{2}$ in) thin card template
- * 26.5 x 26.5cm ($10\frac{1}{2}$ x $10\frac{1}{2}$ in) square of plain teal-coloured fabric
- * 11 x 11cm ($4\frac{1}{2}$ x $4\frac{1}{2}$ in) square of red fabric
- * 10 x 20cm (4 x 8in) piece of patterned teal-coloured fabric, cut and made into four half-square triangles
- * Two 7.5 x 15cm (3 x 6in) rectangles of the same patterned teal-coloured fabric, for the back
- * Toy filling or wadding
- * 2.5cm (1in) button with shank, covered in fabric C
- * 1.5cm ($\frac{5}{8}$ in) plain flat button for the back, used as a washer